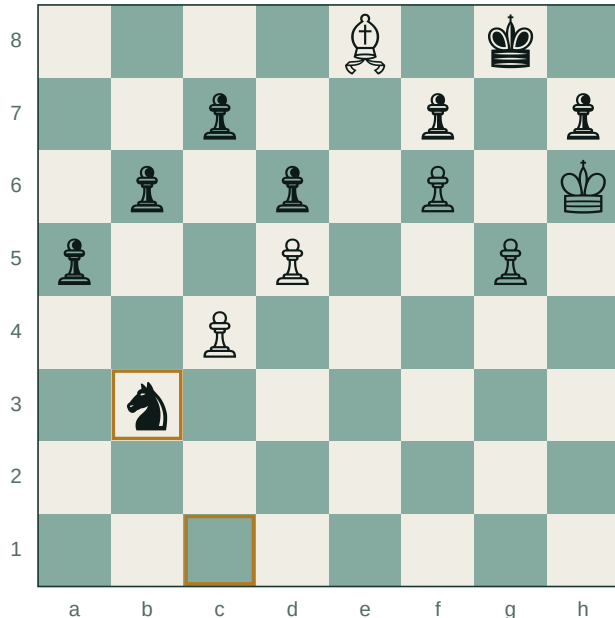


Deflection tactics: White, move 40

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 39...Nxb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Bxf7+ Kxf7 41. Kxh7 Nd2 42. g6+ Kxf6 43. g7

40.Bxf7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f7. Recorded reply: **40...Kxf7**.

41.Kxh7 The king captures the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **41...Nd2**.

42.g6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **42...Kxf6**.

43.g7 The pawn moves from g6 to g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -2 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on b3. Check for tactical protection.